Universal token system · Phase 4

One surface, one honest name.

This very title rides `--surface-inverse` — the dark panel that used to be confusingly spelled `--bg-dark`.

The --bg-dark vs --dark-bg fix.

The collision

`--bg-dark` (a dark panel on a light deck) sat one keystroke from `--dark-bg` (the canvas in dark mode) — opposite roles.

surface-inverse

The dark panel on a light deck — title, divider, closing, split rails, code (was `--bg-dark`).

scheme-dark-*

The dark-color-scheme inputs — the values `light-dark()` resolves to in dark mode (was `--dark-*`).

Kept as-is

`--bg`, `--bg-alt`, `--border` are clear and short — renamed nothing for the sake of it.

This panel is -- surface-inverse too.

Bookends · title, divider, closing

The whole dark-bookend trio paints one surface token. Reading the component CSS now tells you exactly which dark it means.

And the code panel rides it as well.

```
// --code-bg now resolves through --surface-inverse
function panel(scheme) {
  return scheme === "dark"
    ? "--scheme-dark-*"   // the color-scheme inputs
    : "--surface-inverse"; // the dark panel on a light deck
}
```

Phase 4 of 7 · see engineering/decisions/2026-06-11-universal-token-system.md

Surfaces you can read at a glance.